

STRATEGIC OUTREACH · BATCH 01 · FEDERAL R&D

Send, log, and handle replies

The letters are written. What follows is the part that decides whether outreach compounds or evaporates.

- 1 Send Letter 1 and Letter 3 today, from **michael@plastibiofuel.com**. They stand on their own and wait on nothing.
- 2 Attach the Capability Snapshot PDF to both. It is the page that gets forwarded internally when someone decides you are worth passing along.
- 3 Hold Letter 2 until the DOE pitch is submitted on September 10, then send it. If the pitch slips, send it anyway.
- 4 Copy **sbir-sttr@connectwerx.org** on Letter 2. ConnectWerx administers the program and answers faster than the department.
- 5 Log each send in the outreach queue with the date. The next loop run reads that file and will not write the same office twice.
- 6 If no reply in 21 days, send one short follow-up. One. A second follow-up to a federal small business office costs more goodwill than it buys.
- 7 When a reply names a person, that name enters the queue as its own entry with the date and the referral source. A referral is the whole point of the exercise.
- 8 When a reply offers a call, take it and write down what they say about upcoming topics. Topic language is written months before a solicitation posts.

What counts as this working

Not a grant. A name, a notification list, or an invitation to a vendor session. Those are the things that turn the next application from a cold submission into one from a company somebody already recognizes. Three replies out of ten letters would be a good rate for cold federal outreach, and the ones that answer are usually the ones whose job it is to answer.

One rule that protects everything else

Never ask any of these offices about a pending proposal, and never imply that an introduction should bear on a review. Say plainly, as all three letters do, that nothing is being asked for on anything pending. Small business offices talk to program offices, and a company that appears to be working

an angle is remembered for that.